

Out of School Club

Safeguarding (Child Protection) including whistle blowing Policy

Extra time staff are committed to building a 'culture of safety' in which the children in our care are protected from abuse, neglect, harm, radicalization and discrimination and will promptly respond appropriately to all incidents or concerns regarding the safety of a child that may occur. The Club's child protection procedures comply with all relevant legislation and with guidance issued by the Barnsley Safeguarding Children Board (BSCB), we will adhere to the threshold document at all times.

There will be a Child Protection Officer (CPO) available at all times while the Club is in session. The CPO coordinates child protection issues and liaises with the schools named officer and external agencies (eg Social Care(**Newly named - Intergrated Front Door**), the BSCB, LADO and Ofsted).

The Club's designated CPO is **Mandy Grosse (owner)** Who trained as Lead practitioner in safeguarding and refreshes every two years. The Deputy / on-call CPO is **Natalie Walton (Deputy)** also does the two year training for lead practitioner. All information that the staff need, will be given in the staff's induction.

ALL SIGNS AND SYMPTOMS are not exhausted, due to things changing on a daily basis, the 2 Lead officers will ensure that any updates from any training will be disseminated to all of the team, this will be done at each 1-1 staff supervision meeting as well)

We have a notice board on the cupboard, which covers everything for safeguarding, which we all also use as a guide to any queries we have.

All staff must:

- Have an understanding and be able to implement effective child protective procedures, and all of the clubs policies and the Barnsley safeguarding children's board policy.
- Be vigilant, competent and confident to respond to safeguarding situations, as well as identifying physical, emotional or behavioural signs which indicate : signs and symptoms of possible abuse, neglect, harm, radicalisation, discrimination, county lines, cuckooing and child criminal exploitation, and illnesses that are contagious.
- Be aware of the role of observation
- Be able to handle disclosures from others, whether child or adult
- Be able to provide clear written / oral information for the four investigating agencies, BSCB, Police, NSPCC and Ofsted.
- Be able to inform the lead Officer in charge, who will ensure that Ofsted know of the allegations within a 2-day period of the allegation taking place.
- Talk to parents / carers where necessary, (if safe to do so) to let them know we are recording / reporting any incident.

Providers must ensure the staff are trained to identify the following:

- Significant changes in the children's behaviour
- Deterioration in the 'Childs general wellbeing
- Unexplained bruising, marks or signs of possible abuse and / or neglect
- Children's comments which give cause for concern.
- Any other reason to suspect neglect or abuse outside the setting, EG within the 'Childs home.
- Inappropriate behaviour displayed by other members of staff or other adults working with the children. Any sexual comments, excessive one to one attention beyond the usual requirements of their job role, including any inappropriate sharing of images.

What parents / carers should do

- Ask for help when you, your child or family are experiencing difficulties as the staff can signpost to services that can provide early help and support.
- Discuss with a member of staff, any issues which may cause a change in your child's behaviour. For example - a grandparent's death, or a divorce/separation.
- Communicate any safeguarding or welfare concerns you have about your own child or any child within the community.
- Understand that the staff have a duty of care, and to identify concerns and raise them with you if it is appropriate.
- Understand that the staff will not discuss with you any concerns that they have about your child if they feel this may put them at risk of further harm, these concerns will be reported.

Steps to be taken in the event of a child offering a disclosure

- The disclosure needs to be written up on a cause for concern sheet as soon as practicably possible.
- The disclosure needs to be passed to the lead safeguard officer on duty, (unless it describes a disclosure about that person, then it would be passed to the other second LSO)
- That person will then contact social care and OFSTED if necessary, they will offer advice on the way forward.
- The disclosure will be filed in the child's file and completed when we have an outcome.

Guidance on the signs and symptoms of Abuse

What is abuse?

- Abuse and neglect are forms of maltreatment – **a person may abuse or neglect a child by inflicting harm, or by failing to act to prevent harm.** Children may be abused in a family, in an institution or community setting, or over the internet, or be taken out of the country to be abused (in the case of female genital mutilation (FGM)). The abuser's may be; known to them, it may be a stranger's, it may be an adult's or another child/ren or young person's. Some children are more vulnerable than others, disabled children and children who have disabled parents are considerably more vulnerable to abuse.

Neglect

Neglect is a pattern of failing to provide for a child's basic needs, whether it be adequate food, clothing, hygiene, supervision or shelter. It is likely to result in the serious impairment of a child's health or development. Children who are neglected often also suffer from other types of abuse. It is important that practitioners remain alert and do not miss opportunities to take timely action. Neglect may occur if a parent becomes physically or mentally unable to care for a child. A parent may also have an addiction to alcohol or drugs, which could impair their ability to keep a child safe or result in them prioritising buying drugs, or alcohol, over food, clothing or warmth for the child. Neglect may occur in pregnancy because of maternal drug or alcohol abuse.

Physical abuse

Physical abuse is deliberately physically hurting child. It might take a variety of different forms, including hitting, pinching, shaking, throwing, poisoning, burning or scalding, drowning or suffocating a child. Physical abuse can happen in any family, but may be more at risk if their parents have problems with drugs, alcohol and mental health or if they live in a home where domestic abuse happens. Physical harm may also be caused when a parent or carer fabricates the symptoms of, or deliberately induces, illness in a child. Physical abuse can also occur outside of the family environment.

Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)

Female genital mutilation (FGM) includes procedures that intentionally alter or cause injury to the female genital organs for non-medical reasons (**World Health Organisation 2014**). FGM is considered child abuse in the UK and a grave violation of the human rights of girls and women. It is an offence for any person in England, Wales or Northern Ireland (regardless of their nationality or residence status) to perform FGM, or to assist a girl to carry out FGM on herself. It is also an offence to fail to protect a girl from FGM.

Indications that FGM may be about to take place

- The family come from a community that is known to practise FGM.
- Parents state they will take the child out of the country for a prolonged period.
- A child may talk about a long holiday to a country where the practice is prevalent.
- A child may confide that she is to have a “special procedure” or celebration.

Honour Based Violence

So-called honour based violence encompasses crimes which have been committed to protect or defend the honour of a family or community.

Forced Marriage

Forcing a person into a marriage in the UK is a crime. A forced marriage is one entered into without the full consent of one or both parties and where violence, threats or any other form of coercion is used to cause a person to enter into marriage.

Breast ironing

Breast ironing is a traditional practice in some parts of West Africa, usually arranged or performed by a girl's mother to make her less attractive to males by delaying the signs that the girl is maturing into a young woman. It usually starts when a girl begins to develop breasts, generally between 8 and 12 years of age.

Sexual Abuse and Exploitation

Sexual abuse is any sexual activity with a child. You should be aware that many children and young people who are victims of sexual abuse do not recognise themselves as such. A child may not understand what is happening and may not even understand that it is wrong. It may involve physical contact, including assault by penetration (for example rape or oral sex) or non-penetrative acts such as masturbation, kissing, rubbing and touching outside of clothing. It may also include non-contact activities, such as involving children in looking at, or in the production of sexual images, watching sexual activities, encouraging children to behave in sexually inappropriate ways, or grooming a child in preparation for abuse (including via the internet). Sexual abuse is not solely perpetrated by adult males, women can also commit acts of sexual abuse, as can other children.

Sexual exploitation is a form of sexual abuse where children are sexually exploited for money, power or status. It can involve, humiliating and degrading sexual assaults. In some cases, young people are persuaded or forced into exchanging sexual activity for money, drugs, gifts, affection or status. Consent cannot be given, even where a child may believe they are voluntarily engaging in sexual activity with the person who is exploiting them. A significant number of children who are victims of sexual exploitation go missing from home, care or education at some point.

Emotional Abuse

Emotional abuse is the persistent emotional maltreatment of a child. It is sometimes known as psychological abuse and it can have severe and persistent adverse effects on the child's emotional development. Although the effects of emotional abuse might take a long time to be recognisable, practitioners will be in a position to observe it, for example in the way a parent interacts with their child. It may include deliberately telling a child that they are worthless, or unloved and inadequate. It may include not giving the child opportunities to express their views, deliberately silencing them or 'making fun' of what they say or how they communicate. It may involve serious bullying -including online bullying through social networks, online games or mobile phones-by a child's peers.

Contextual safeguarding

Safeguarding incidents can be associated with, and occur between, children outside of school. All staff, especially the designated safeguarding lead and their deputies, need to consider the context within which such incidents occur. This is known as contextual safeguarding; assessments of children must consider if wider environmental factors present in a child's life are a threat to their safety or welfare.

Children's social care assessments should consider these factors, so it's important that we provide as much information as possible as part of any referral made. This allows any assessment to consider all the available evidence and the full context of any abuse.

You can find out more in the DfE publication **Keeping Children Safe in Education. Which was updated 2023**

County lines, cuckooing and child criminal exploitation

County lines are the organised criminal distribution of drugs from the big cities into smaller towns and rural areas using children and vulnerable people. Drugs such as cocaine, heroin and amphetamines are the main focus of county lines, although cannabis is also sometimes linked to this as well.

Where County Lines operate

The main county line gangs operate from London, and Liverpool, but other groups work out of other large cities, such as Manchester, Birmingham and Reading. The gangs are able to operate more easily in quieter areas where they might not be known to the police.

The influence of county lines in nationwide: Metropolitan Police found gang members from Islington in 14 different police areas.

What happens

Young people, typically 15 or 16 but sometimes younger, travel by public transport into rural or coastal areas carrying drugs and a disposable phone.

For the gangs security, each runner along the delivery chain only knows one other phone number.

Cuckooing

If a drug runner needs a place to stay, the gang will take over a home of a vulnerable person, often after following them home. This is known as cuckooing.

Once in the property, drugs and weapons can be stored there, as well as using it as a venue for dealing drugs and the sexual exploitation of girls and young women.

Signs of child abuse and neglect

Signs of possible abuse and neglect may include:

- significant changes in a child's behaviour
- deterioration in a child's general well-being
- unexplained bruising or marks
- comments made by a child which give cause for concern
- Inappropriate behaviour displayed by a member of staff, or any other person. For example, inappropriate sexual comments, excessive one-to-one attention beyond the requirements of their role, or inappropriate sharing of images.

If any of the above signs and symptoms of abuse are identified, actions will be taken if:

- ***there has been persistent or severe neglect of a child which results in serious impairment of the child's health or development including failure to thrive.***
- ***There are severe adverse effects on the behaviour and emotional development of the child caused by persistent or severe ill treatment or rejection***
- ***There has been a physical injury to a child, including deliberate poisoning or where there is a definite knowledge or reasonable suspicion that the injury was inflicted or knowingly not prevented.***
- ***There has been an injury or injuries observed connected to sexual abuse or witnessed occasions when a child indicates sexual activity through play, drawings or has an excessive pre occupation with sexual matters or has an inappropriate knowledge of adult sexual behaviour.***

What extra time staff will do

If a disclosure is made: that member of staff will responsible for the recording of discussions on the cause for concern sheet, they will:

- reassure the child / young person that they were not to blame and were right to speak out
- listen to the child but not question them
- give reassurance that the staff member will take action
- Record the incident as soon as possible (see *Logging an incident* below).
- Under no circumstances must they coax the child into a disclosure.
- Don't make any promises
- Always tell the child exactly what you are going to do next, in words they will understand.
- Do NOT make any accusations
- Do not inform parents/carers of your concerns and / or referral. This is the responsibility of the Local Safeguarding Children's Board (LSCB)

Providers must have regards to the governments guidance "working together to safeguard children 2018, and "keeping children safe in Education 2016". If providers have concerns about the child's safety or welfare, they MUST notify the agencies without delay.

If a member of staff witnesses or suspects abuse, they will record the matter straightaway using the **cause for concern** form. If a third party expresses concern that a child is being abused, we will encourage them to contact **intergrated front door**. If they will not do so, we will explain that the Club is obliged to and the incident will be logged accordingly.

Peer-on-peer abuse

Children are vulnerable to abuse by their peers. Peer-on-peer abuse is taken seriously by staff and will be subject to the same child protection procedures as other forms of abuse. Staff are aware of the potential uses of information technology for bullying and abusive behaviour between young people.

Staff will not dismiss abusive behaviour as normal between young people. The presence of one or more of the following in relationships between children should always trigger concern about the possibility of peer-on-peer abuse:

- Sexual activity (in primary school-aged children) of any kind, including sexting
- One of the children is significantly more dominant than the other (eg much older)
- One of the children is significantly more vulnerable than the other (eg in terms of disability, confidence, physical strength)
- There has been some use of threats, bribes or coercion to ensure compliance or secrecy.

If peer-on-peer abuse is suspected or disclosed

We will follow the same procedures as set out above for responding to child abuse.

Extremism and radicalisation

All childcare settings have a legal duty to protect children from the risk of radicalisation and being drawn into extremism. Under the counter terrorism and security Act 2015. Which is also known as the **prevent Duty**. There are many reasons why a child might be vulnerable to radicalisation, eg:

- feeling alienated or alone
- seeking a sense of identity or individuality
- suffering from mental health issues such as depression
- desire for adventure or wanting to be part of a larger cause
- associating with others who hold extremist beliefs

Signs of radicalisation

Signs that a child might be at risk of radicalisation include:

- changes in behaviour, for example becoming withdrawn or aggressive
- claiming that terrorist attacks and violence are justified
- viewing violent extremist material online
- possessing or sharing violent extremist material

If a member of staff suspects that a child is at risk of becoming radicalised, they will record any relevant information or observations on a **Cause for concern** form, and refer the matter to the CPO.

Logging a concern

For concerns about **child abuse**, the CPO will contact **intergrated front door** immediately. The CPO will follow up all referrals to **intergrated front door** in writing within 48 hours. If a member of staff thinks that the incident has not been dealt with properly, they may contact **intergrated front door** directly.

For minor concerns regarding **radicalisation**, the CPO will contact the Barnsley Safeguarding Children Board (BSCB) For more serious concerns the CPO will contact the Police on the non-emergency number (101), or the anti-terrorist hotline on 0800 789 321. For urgent concerns the CPO will contact the Police using 999.

Allegations against staff or any other adult within the setting

Our aims

We aim to ensure that NO member of staff/adult is left open to possible allegations from anyone, Therefore we ensure that there is a minimum of two staff on duty at all times.

The procedures are based on the framework for dealing with allegations made against a person who works with children and should be applied where there is an allegation that a person who works with children, who has:

- Behaved in a way that has harmed a child or may have harmed a child.
- Possibly committed a criminal offence against or related to a child.
- Behaved towards a child / children in a way that indicates she/he is unsuitable to work with children
- Concerns arise about a person's behaviour in private or within the community life of our families.

If an allegation was to be made about a member of staff, then the following action would take place:

RECOGNISING AND RESPONDING TO AN ALLEGATION:

Different sources of where a complaint or allegation may arise from and include:

- A child / Adult
- A parent
- A member of staff against another staff member
- A member of the public
- Disciplinary Investigation

If an allegation /concern is reported, then the person of whom it was reported to should not investigate the matter further or question the person making the allegation, they should:

All information about the suspected abuse or disclosure, or concern about radicalisation, will be recorded on the **cause for concern** form as soon as possible after the event.

- Treat the matter seriously
- Avoid asking any leading questions and keep an open mind.

- Communicate with the person in a way that they can understand The initial enquiries are only to ascertain specific information, such as any history of any allegations being made by this individual / family previously, and any history of any allegations being made against the individual being accused in the past, whether the allegation is 'possible' (meaning were the people involved actual where they were alleged to have been at the time of the alleged incident, at the alleged time)
- Make a written record of all of the information given on a cause for concern form.(in the persons own words) including:

When the alleged incident took place, time and date.

Who was present?

What was said to have happened?

- Sign and date the written document.
- Report it IMMEDIATELY to the lead safeguarding officer, unless the incident includes that person, then it would go to the deputy Lead officer.

The designated officer, should then contact and report the incident to LADO and OFSTED within 1 working day of receiving the information.

SUPPORTING THOSE INVOLVED:

Children – Will be provided with support where ever possible, especially if they have suffered significant harm or are included in any criminal prosecution or preparation for court.

Parent / carer – Will be informed of the allegation, if LADO sees fit that the allegation has a foundation. They will be kept informed about the progress of the case. Told the outcome where there is not a criminal prosecution. They will also be told of any disciplinary outcomes.

The Person involved – Will be treat fairly and honestly and helped to understand the concerns expressed and the processes that are involved in the allegation. They will be kept informed of the progress of the case and the outcomes of any investigations. They will also be kept informed of any developments in the workplace if they have been suspended. The will be advised at the beginning of the process to contact their union representative if they have one.

An allegation will be made if a staff member:

- *behaved in a way that has harmed a child, or may have harmed a child;*
- *possibly committed a criminal offence against or related to a child; or*
- *behaved towards a child or children in a way that indicates he or she would pose a risk of harm to children.*
- The allegation must be reported, initially to their line manager to the Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO) within one working day where possible, but has to be definitely done within 2 working days, also ensuring that Ofsted are informed. The LADO will advise if other agencies (eg police) should be informed, and the Club will act upon their advice. Any telephone reports to the LADO will be followed up in writing within 48 hours.
- Following advice from the LADO, it may be necessary to suspend the member of staff pending full investigation of the allegation. This will however, be after initial enquiries have been made, to ascertain specific information, such as history of allegations by the individual/family, and whether the allegation is possible!
- Ofsted will be informed in the event of an allegation as soon as is practicably possible but not exceeding 14 days after the allegation is made.
- Any allegations made in the setting will be shared with the designated leads within one working day of them being reported.
- If appropriate the Club or the Local Authority or the LADO will make a referral to the Disclosure and Barring Service (if the person has been dismissed, or would have been had they not resigned, as it is believed or substantiated, that they have or may harm a child.

Suspending a staff member / other adult

Suspension isn't to be considered as an automatic option. This would only take place if:

- There is cause to suspect a child is at risk or harm.
- The allegation is to be investigated by the police
- The allegation may be serious enough for grounds for dismissal.

Resignations

If a member of staff decides to resign, this doesn't mean that the allegation follow up will stop. The allegation will be followed up as stated above and a conclusion will be reached.

The owner / manager cannot accept a member of staffs' resignation on the grounds that the allegation will go no further.

Disciplinary regarding the allegation

After the allegation has concluded, it will then be determined by LADO and the owner / Manager (unless otherwise) which disciplinary route will be taken. – [See disciplinary Procedure](#)

Record keeping and recording outcomes

The owner / manager should keep a clear summary of the case recorded in the persons file and give a copy to the person involved.

The record should only contain details of the allegation. Nothing malicious or discriminatory.

Allegation outcomes are as follows:

- **Substantiated** - there is enough evidence to prove the allegation
- **False** - there is enough evidence to disprove the allegation
- **Malicious** - there is evidence that the allegation was reported on purpose
- **Unfounded** - there is no evidence or correct basis which supports the allegation.
- **Unsubstantiated** - there is insufficient evidence to prove or disprove the allegation.

Promoting awareness among staff

The Club promotes awareness of child abuse and the risk of radicalisation through its staff external training. The Club ensures that:

- the designated lead has relevant experience and receives appropriate training in safeguarding and the Prevent Duty, and is aware of the Channel Programme and how to access it
- designated person training is refreshed every **two** years
- safe recruitment practices are followed for all new staff
- all staff have a copy of this **Safeguarding (Child Protection) policy**, understand its contents and are vigilant to signs of abuse, neglect or radicalisation
- all staff are aware of their statutory duties with regard to the disclosure or discovery of child abuse, and concerns about radicalisation
- all other staff receive basic safeguarding training, and safeguarding is a permanent agenda item at all staff meetings
- all staff receive basic training in the Prevent Duty
- staff are familiar with the Safeguarding File which is kept in the brown cupboard, with the other files
- the Club's procedures are in line with the guidance in 'Working Together to Safeguard Children (the up to date booklet)

Use of mobile phones, cameras and other items such as watches (anything with imaging and sharing capabilities)

Photographs will only be taken of children with their parents' permission. Only the club camera will be used to take photographs of children at the Club, except with the express permission of the manager. Neither staff nor children may use their mobile phones or other imaging and sharing devices to take photographs at the Club. We have a full and inclusive policy on the use of mobile phones, cameras and other digital imaging on file in club.

Contact numbers

Social Care (intergrated front door) (Child Assessment Service) : 01226 772423 (845-5pm mon-thurs, 845-430pm fri)

Social Care (intergrated front door) out of hours contact emergency Duty team: 01226 787789

Disable Childrens team: 01226 774050

childrensintergratedfrontdoor@barnsley.gov.uk

LADO (Local Authority Designated Officer):: 01226 772341 or 07969529779

LADO@barnsley.gov.uk

(OR call the safeguarding unit 01226 772400 if LADO not available when you call, they will take a message)

Police **prevent duty** team: 0114 2523217 (8-4pm)

Crimestoppers – 0800555111

Secure email (prevent concern: prevent@southyorks.pnn.policswe.uk

Police: 101 (non-emergency)

999 (emergency)

Secure email can be sent to Prevent_Inbox@southyorks.pnn.police.uk

Anti-terrorist hotline: 0800 789 321

NSPCC: 0808 800 500

Ofsted: 0300 123 1231

This policy was adopted by: Mandy Grosse	Date: 7 th May 2025
To be reviewed: May 2026	Signed:

I the undersigned, have read and understood the policy, and will always adhere to it.

A Grosse:

Date:

N Walton:

Date:

H. Bailey:

Date:

T. Quinn:

Date:

M. Wright:

Date: